

Giant sequoia

Towering above all the other trees in the forest, the giant sequoia (se-kwoy-a) is hard to miss. These monster trees are nature's skyscrapers. The tallest one alive is 84 m (276 ft) high. In the USA, there are some sequoias that have had tunnels carved into their trunks so vehicles can drive through them!

The giant sequoia is also known as the giant redwood because of its rusty-coloured bark. This bark is thick and spongy, which helps protect the tree from forest fires. Sequoias are a type of conifer, with thin, needle-like leaves and cones filled with seeds. Despite the trees' huge size, sequoia cones are only 5 cm (2 in) wide.

*There are sequoias 3,500 years old,
which took root when pharaohs
ruled Ancient Egypt.*

